

Since you're new to web development but familiar with coding pure HTML, CSS, and JavaScript in VS Code, I'll guide you step-by-step to set up a simple web project. Don't worry if you're feeling confused—we'll break it down into clear, manageable steps so you can create a basic website with a homepage, some styling, and interactivity. Let's get started!

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**Step 1: Set Up Your Project Folder** Every web project needs an organized structure. Here's how to set yours up:

- Create a new folder on your computer called `MyFirstWebsite`. This will hold all your project files.
- Inside this folder, create:
  - A file named `index.html` (your main webpage).
  - A folder named `css` (for your styles).
    - Inside `css`, create a file named `styles.css`.
  - A folder named `js` (for your JavaScript).
    - Inside `js`, create a file named `scripts.js`.

Your folder should look like this:

`MyFirstWebsite/`

`|— index.html`

`|— css/`

`| └─ styles.css`

`|— js/`

`└─ scripts.js`

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**Step 2: Write Your HTML** The `index.html` file is where your website begins. It defines the structure of your page. Since you're used to pure HTML, this will feel familiar. Open `index.html` in VS Code and add this code:

`html`

`<!DOCTYPE html>`

```
<html lang="en">
<head>
  <meta charset="UTF-8">
  <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
  <title>My First Website</title>
  <link rel="stylesheet" href="css/styles.css">
</head>
<body>
  <header>
    <h1>Welcome to My Website</h1>
  </header>
  <main>
    <p>This is a paragraph of text.</p>
    <button id="myButton">Click Me!</button>
  </main>
  <footer>
    <p>&copy; 2025 MyFirstWebsite</p>
  </footer>
  <script src="js/scripts.js"></script>
</body>
</html>
```

What's happening here?

- The <head> section has metadata and links to your styles.css file for styling.
  - The <body> contains what users see: a header, a paragraph, a button, and a footer.
  - The <script> tag links to scripts.js for interactivity.
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Step 3: Add Some CSSCSS makes your website look good. Open `css/styles.css` in VS Code and add this:

```
css
```

```
body {  
    font-family: Arial, sans-serif;  
    margin: 0;  
    padding: 0;  
}
```

```
header {  
    background-color: #333;  
    color: white;  
    padding: 10px;  
    text-align: center;  
}
```

```
main {  
    padding: 20px;  
}
```

```
footer {  
    background-color: #333;  
    color: white;  
    text-align: center;  
    padding: 10px;  
    position: fixed;
```

```
bottom: 0;
width: 100%;
}
```

What's happening here?

- We're styling the body to use a clean font and remove default spacing.
  - The header and footer get a dark background and centered white text.
  - The main section has padding for spacing.
  - The footer sticks to the bottom of the page.
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Step 4: Add JavaScript for InteractivityJavaScript adds functionality. Open `js/scripts.js` and add this:

javascript

```
document.getElementById('myButton').addEventListener('click', function() {
    alert('Button clicked!');
});
```

What's happening here?

- When you click the button (with `id="myButton"`), a pop-up says "Button clicked!"
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Step 5: Open Your Project in VS CodeSince you use VS Code, here's how to load your project:

- Open VS Code.
  - Go to File > Open Folder and select `MyFirstWebsite`.
  - Your files will appear in the left sidebar. Click any file to edit it.
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Step 6: Preview Your WebsiteTo see your website, you have two options. Since you're new, I recommend using Live Server in VS Code—it auto-refreshes your page when you make changes.Install Live Server:

- In VS Code, click the Extensions icon on the left (or press `Ctrl+Shift+X`).

- Search for “Live Server” (by Ritwick Dey).
- Click Install.

Use Live Server:

- Right-click index.html in VS Code’s file explorer.
- Select Open with Live Server.
- Your browser will open, showing your website. Save changes to any file, and the page will update automatically.

Alternative: Double-click index.html in your file explorer to open it in a browser. You’ll need to refresh manually to see changes.

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### Step 7: Experiment and See Changes

- Change the <h1> text in index.html to “Hello, World!” and save. Watch it update.
- In styles.css, change header { background-color: #333; } to #ff0000 (red) and save.
- In scripts.js, change the alert to 'You clicked me!' and test the button.

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Step 8: Debug if Needed If something doesn’t work (e.g., the button doesn’t trigger), use the browser’s developer tools:

- Right-click on your webpage and select Inspect.
- Click the Console tab to see errors.
- Explore the Elements tab to check your HTML and CSS.

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### Bonus Tips for VS Code

- Faster HTML with Emmet: Type div.container and press Tab to get <div class="container"></div>. It’s built into VS Code!
- Code Formatting: Install the Prettier extension:
  - Go to Extensions (Ctrl+Shift+X).
  - Search “Prettier - Code formatter” and install.

- Right-click in a file and select Format Document to tidy your code.
  - Adding Images: Create an images folder in MyFirstWebsite. Add an image (e.g., myimage.jpg), then use it in HTML: ``.
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SummaryYou've just set up a basic web project with HTML, CSS, and JavaScript in VS Code!  
Here's what you did:

- Created a project folder with index.html, css/styles.css, and js/scripts.js.
- Linked your CSS and JS files to HTML.
- Added structure (HTML), styling (CSS), and interactivity (JS).
- Used Live Server to preview your work live.
- Learned to debug with browser tools.

You're off to a great start! Play around with the code—add more elements, styles, or functions. As you get comfortable, you can explore bigger projects or new techniques. Happy coding!